

Date 2026-04-10

I have another inkling of an idea. Another iteration. Another thread to tug on. This entire endeavor is just me trying to better understand and hack my own psychology. For good, though. To get me aiming for something valuable, tangible, meaningful. And I am building up evidence to prove to myself that my success is inevitable. Clarity is key. Keep digging. Keep asking why. Don't let myself off the hook but rather press, encourage, explore. Try. Fail. Learn. Adapt. Try. Try. Try. Fail. Fail. Fail. No attempt is wasted or wasteful. The only thing to avoid AT ALL COST is the lack of effort. The not trying. Keep at it. You got this.

Date 2026-04-11

Comparison is the thief of joy. I know this. There is always some satisfaction that comes from knowing you're doing better than someone else but even that is so relative and lacks context. And there is always someone you'll find doing so much better than you. It's the realization that comparison just doesn't make sense. We got too much to focus on in my life to worry about how someone else is doing in comparison. I can learn from others though and I should do that consistently. When thinking about my app, I shouldn't think what should I build next, but rather what do I need to make me more comfortable and less anxious coming into and out of my week. How can I build confidence in what I'm building and get faster

2 Timothy 2:15-16

For the evil desires of youth and passions fight against
faith, love, and peace, along with those who call
on the Lord out of a pure heart. Don't have anything
to do with foolish and stupid arguments,
because you know they produce quarrels. And the
Lord's servant must not be quarrelsome but must
be kind to everyone, able to teach, not resentful.
Opponents must be gently instructed, in the hope that
God will grant them repentance leading them to
a knowledge of the truth, and that they will come
to their senses and escape from the trap of the
devil, who has taken them captive to do his will.

Date 2016-04-08

Yesterday felt a bit like a struggle. Strong start but
several fumbles throughout the day. I have
felt pretty good about my mornings. I am struggling
to get out of bed when my alarm goes off at
four but I have been getting up by 14:30. I need
to keep that momentum going. My mileage has
been up significantly as well. I want to keep that
going but I need to be hyper aware of what my
body is telling me as I don't want to risk injury.
I need to work on being by myself and how I feel
and use my time. Selectively use my procrastination
to my advantage with actions I know I shouldn't
take and have a bias to action on the things I know
I should. I can be smart about this using my own
psychology as an

2 Timothy 2:22-26

Follow the evil desires of youth and pursue righteousness, faith, love, and peace, along with those who call on the Lord out of a pure heart. Don't have anything to do with foolish and stupid arguments, because you know they produce quarrels. And the Lord's servant must not be quarrelsome but must be kind to everyone, able to teach, not resentful. Opponents must be gently instructed, in the hope that God will grant them repentance leading them to a knowledge of the truth, and that they will come to their senses and escape from the trap of the devil, who has taken them captive to do his will.

Date 2026-04-08

Yesterday felt a bit like a struggle. Strong start but several humbles throughout the day. I have felt pretty good about my morning. I am struggling to get out of bed when my alarm goes off at 6am but I have been getting up by 14:30. I need to keep that momentum going. My weekend has been up significantly as well. I want to keep that going but I need to be hyper aware of what my body is telling me as I don't want to risk injury. I need to work on being by myself and how I habit and use my time. Selectively use my procrastination to my advantage with actions I know I shouldn't take and have a bias to action on the things I know I should. I can be smart about this using my own psychology as an asset not a liability.

I struggle to understand what we're doing, why we're doing it, to know what we should and should not be working on next. Am I just thinking of random stuff to keep us busy or is there intent and purpose driving what we are doing? What does being a product team have to do with it? What about an operational or execution team? Are we all product teams? I try to relate every as algorithms of projects. Back ends, front ends, data structures, APIs and connectors / plug ins / pipelines. What is needed from me specifically. What part do I play in the macro system? What are my expectations for my system? How am I looking at the micro systems. How do the micro come together to form the macro? Am I reacting to what I see and making system impacting decisions based on highly localized data versus shaping the individual micro systems because of the macro vision I have.

Date 2016-03-23

Am I struggling right now or are things just starting to make sense? I feel like I should be overwhelmed but I'm not. There's a lot going on right now, sure, but it seems manageable. My AI profile that I'm working on building is a bit eye opening. Nothing really surprising but there are some parts that stick. I realize that synopsis is still missing context and lacks the nuance that has been making. This isn't

One of the things that's very important to me is making a system that is actually valuable. Something that I want to use and when used provides value.

Home: Hearth and Inspector
~~cut ceiling and fix~~
~~Hamburger loans and loans~~
~~fix sink drain~~
 Taxes
~~HVAC scheduling Phoenix~~
~~Regal Port control renewal~~

Date 2026-03-21

making a system then filling it with data vs. creating, collecting, organizing data then creating a system to work with it.

I desire clarity of the underlying foundation, fundamentals that would then inform the frontend, the system itself.

Making for the sake of making vs. creating something that gives clarity, understanding and direction to my thoughts and actions.

vision mission purpose, objectives and key results
 why do I think it's do what I do?

- Elizabeth sent me a number of books to find.
- 3D printer
- camera system for car
- Chappague building department
- ~~Class registration, email response~~
- ~~Pay Regal pest control~~
- ~~schedule spring HVAC maintenance~~
- clean down stairs

Conversations - I need really clean, tight transcripts
 - I believe I can do so much with a transcript
 versus a conversation summary.

Wisdom means timing, discernment, and understanding
 your environment. Gracious speech isn't just being
 nice - it's being intentional, truthful, and seasoned
 with salt. Salt preserves and enhances. That's
 what our words should do: bring life, preserve
 truth, and reflect the heart of Jesus.

Cast all your anxiety on Him because he cares for you.
 1 Peter 5:7

coding the startups that will destroy the existing businesses.

The same thing is happening to you. You're going soft. You're not aggressive enough. You're not pressing ahead. You've got a million reasons why you can't move at a faster pace. This all makes the obstacles in your life look very large.

What does my next look like?

Always think with your stick forward.

Stay moving. Always.

Those who attack problems and life with the most initiative and energy usually win.

We talk a lot about courage as a society, but we forget that at its most basic level it's really just taking action.

If you want momentum, you'll have to create it yourself.

I feel overwhelming love this morning. I had a positive experience, demonstration of love with each of my family members this morning. And told each of them that I loved them. I feel like I performed my duties as a loving father and husband. This brings me joy bringing my family joy and making them feel loved. I can be patient and kind today. I feel really good right now. But I am tired. I'm good but feel close to empty. I think it's just a lack of sleep.

Book Notes:

We must all either wear out or rust out, every one of us. My choice is to wear out.

- Theodore Roosevelt

Start. Anywhere. Anyhow. Don't care if the conditions are perfect or if you're being slighted. Know that once you get started, if you can build some momentum, you can make it work. Take the opening and then press ahead.

We often assume the world moves at our leisure. We delay when we should initiate. We jog when we should be running, or better yet, sprinting. And then we're shocked when nothing big ever happens, when opportunities never show up. When obstacles begin to pile up. So the first step is to take the hat off your shoulder and give it a swing. You've got to start to go anywhere.

Where Rome is, there is the front.

Book notes:

Demosthenes lost the inheritance he was born with and that was unfortunate. But in the process of dealing with this reality, he created a far better one - one that could never be taken from him.

We don't think, we don't complain, we don't argue. We act. We have real strength - more strength than we know.

It feels better to ignore or pretend. But you know deep down that that isn't going to truly make it any better. You've got to act. And you've got to start now.

In life, it doesn't matter what happens to you or where you come from. It matters what you do with what happens and what you've been given. And the only way you'll do something spectacular is by using it all to your advantage.

We don't have the luxury of running away. Of hiding. No one is coming to save you. And if we'd like to go where we claim we want to go - to accomplish what we claim are our goals - there is only one way. And that's to meet our problems with the right action.

Book Notes:

Blessings and burdens are not mutually exclusive.

Psychologists call it adversarial growth and post-traumatic growth. "That which doesn't kill us, makes us stronger." is not just cliché but fact.

The extent of the struggle determines the extent of the growth. The obstacle is an advantage, not adversity. The enemy is any perception that prevents us from seeing this.

Problems are precisely as bad as we think.

A clearer head makes for steadier hands.

Date 2016-02-12

Where are the areas in my life I can clothe myself with the fruits of the Spirit? Where can I be more patient, kind, gentle, humble, compassionate? Can I be more forgiving? more loving? What do those things actually look like in application? How can I be those things to Elizabeth? What about to my kids? My Verizon team? My siblings? To myself?

Book notes:

Action is commonplace. Right action is not. As a discipline it's not any kind of action that will do, just directed action. Everything must be done in the service of the whole.

Action is the solution to our predicaments.

extraordinary. He was Napoleon shouting to his soldiers
"There shall be no alps!"

Because though our doubts (and self doubts) feel real, they
have very little bearing on what is and isn't possible.
Our perceptions determine, to an incredibly large degree,
what we are and are not capable of.

Jobs refused to tolerate people who don't believe in their
own abilities to succeed. Even if his demands were
unfair, uncomfortable, or ambitious.

Date 2016-02-06

A good person dyes events with his own color... and
turns whatever happens to his own benefit.
- Seneca.

It's one thing to not be overwhelmed by obstacles, or
discouraged or upset by them. This is something that
few are able to do. But after you have controlled your
emotions, and you can see objectively and stand steadily
the next step becomes possible: a mental flip, so
you're looking not at the obstacle but at the opportunity
within it.

There is good in everything, if only we look for it.
- Laura Legall Wilder

Date 2026-02-04

Tomorrow I need to do my coverage mapping. I'm probably the last one to do it but oh well. I do need to dedicate time to it though. Tomorrow I need to run at least four miles. I think I can. I also need to get my native conversation ready. This is a big step and a great opportunity.

Date 2026-02-05

There is a lot going on right now but I am in a fog of war state where I can't see where this is going. I can feel the winds approaching, the momentum building but I don't know how this is going to play out. It is well with my soul no matter what the conclusion is. I trust in you Father. I trust in where you are leading.

Book notes:

Crisis is the ability to get into effect what is in your mind. There is no other definition of it.
- F. Scott Fitzgerald

Having learned early in life that reality was falsely summed in by rules and compromises that people had been taught as children, Gols had a much more aggressive idea of what was or wasn't possible. To him, when you factored in vision and work ethic, much of life was malleable.

Gols view of reality at work: malleable, adaptable, self-confident. Not in the delusional sense but for the purposes of accomplishing something. He knew that to aim low meant to accept mediocre accomplishment. But a high aim could, if things went right create something

To see an obstacle as a challenge, to make the best of it anyway, that is also a choice - a choice that is up to us.

Most people start from disadvantage (often with no idea they are doing so) and do just fine. It's not unfair, it's universal.

For all species other than us humans, things just are what they are. Our problem is that we're always trying to figure out what things mean - why things are the way they are. As though the why matters. Emerson put it best: "We cannot spend the day in explanation." Don't waste time on false constructs.

The implications of our obstacle are theoretical - they exist in the past and the future. We live in the moment. And the more we embrace that, the easier the obstacle will be to face and move.

I knocked more items off my todo list today. I am really hoping I get the fireplace installed tomorrow. Ready to get that project wrapped up.

Thank you Father for this day and all that I was able to accomplish today. Fitzrulestone reached as we finally got the fireplace installed. I will be heading back to the city tomorrow if hopefully get my head back down. I still have too much to do. I hate TikTok. Really don't like overhearing it.

if resilience is what I'm after, I can't score the things that strengthen that muscle. I must accept it and embrace it. Not criticizing the weights but understanding the role they play in building strength. So what are the characteristics, qualities that I am trying to build? This is all an uphill climb but honestly that's what makes achievement and accomplishment feel so fulfilling. I was made to do hard things. And I am loved unconditionally through the whole journey.

Book Notes:

Tommy John understood that as a professional athlete his job was to parse the difference between the unlikely and the impossible. Seeing that minuscule distinction was what made him who he was.

God grant me the serenity to accept the things I cannot change, The courage to change the things I can, And the wisdom to know the difference.

What is up to me?

What is not up to me?

To argue, to complain, to just give up, these are choices. Choice that more often than not do nothing to get us across the finish line.

The most harmful dragon we can chase is the one that makes us think we can change the things that are simply not ours to change.

Focusing exclusively on what is in our power magnifies and enhances our power.

, have a lot of stuff to do today. Much of which should have been done over the weekend yet here I am, not having done it. Alas this is a new day and I will tackle it today. A million things are going to fight for my attention. I need to focus on the next right action.

Book notes:

What we can do is limit and expand our perspective to whatever will keep us calmest and most ready for the task at hand. Think of it as selective editing not to deceive others but to properly orient ourselves. Where the head goes the body follows. Perception precedes action. Right action follows the right perspective.

In life our first job is this, to divide and distinguish things into two categories: externals I cannot control but the choices I make with regard to them I do control. Where will I find good and bad? In me, in my choices.
- Epictetus

This was a crazy productive day. I was able to check many things off my todo list.
Tomorrow I need to reach out to the architect to follow up on the proposal

I was on the treadmill by 4:45 this morning and that extra 15 min felt like it made all the difference. I got four miles in, didn't feel washed at all. Got my lunch. Got a breakfast protein shake with greens. Walked to the train station. Feeling pretty pumped so far today. However! Now that I think about it, I did not speak to my mom yesterday or my grandmother. I need to prioritize that today. Make those connections, Andrew.

Things to capture in my weekly notes:

- Themes
- accomplishments
- to dos - from me, from my team
- any goal tracking
- What was top of mind this week

Book Notes:

"Man does not simply exist but always decides what his existence will be, what he will become the next moment. By the same token, every human being has the freedom to change at any instant." Viktor Frankl

"Perspective is everything. When you can break apart something, or look at it from a new angle, it loses its power over you."

Take what you're afraid of - when fear strikes you - and break it apart. Explain it away. We choose how we will look at things.

The perceiving eye brings its own issues to a fight which is not helpful. To paraphrase Nietzsche, sometimes being superficial - taking things only at first glance - is the most profound approach.

We can question the immediate impulse to run, to react. We can disagree with it. We can override the switch, examine the threat before we act. But this takes strength. It's a muscle that must be developed. And muscles are developed by tension, by lifting and holding.

"Man does not simply exist but always decides what his existence will be, what he will become the next moment. By the same token, every human being has the freedom to change at any instant."

- Viktor Frankl

Today was a solid day. Tomorrow I have work to do for both Kate and Galie and Allison. I also need to review my notes for the day. I have been working out pretty consistently lately. The pilates with the running has been pretty good. I should try to do three miles again tomorrow but I really need to get an earlier start. Hopefully I'll fall right to sleep tonight. Maybe I can speak with Joseph tomorrow about his degree path with VeriSign.

Date 2026-01-27

"Don't let the force of an impression when it first hit you knock you off your feet; just say to it: Hold on a moment; let me see who you are and what you represent. Let me put you to the test."
- Epictetus

Date 2026-01-28

I feel the weight today to reach out to my mother in law and ask her how she's doing. I also need to connect with my grandmother and my siblings. That can be my focus this afternoon - to sit down and write to my MIL and call my grandmother when I get home this evening. I feel as though I am about to embark on a great journey not knowing how it will unfold. But I am at peace with it. Too many pieces aligning for me to pass it up. Time to start a new adventure. Today I need to figure out the process for internal Versipen approval and then request transcripts.

Book Notes:

"Don't let the force of an impression when it first hit you knock you off your feet; just say to it: Hold on a moment; let me see who you are and what you represent. Let me put you to the test."
- Epictetus

"The perceiving eye is weak, the observing eye is strong. Musashi understood that the observing eye sees simply what is there. The perceiving eye sees more than what is there."

"situations by themselves, cannot be good or bad."
 "Nothing either good or bad, but thinking makes it so."
 Shakespeare.

"through our perception of events, we are complicit in the creation - as well as the destruction of every one of our obstacles. There is no good or bad without us, there is only perception. There is the event itself and the story we tell ourselves about what it means."

"Just because your mind tells you something doesn't mean you have to agree."

"What such a man needs is not courage but nerve control, cool headedness. This he only can get by practice."
 Theodore Roosevelt

"In these situations, talent is not the most sought after characteristic. Grace and poise are, because these two attributes precede the opportunity to deploy any other skill."

"Ultimately nerve is a matter of defiance and control."

"When people panic, they make mistakes. They override systems. They disregard procedures, ignore rules. They deviate from the plan. They become unresponsive and stop thinking clearly. They just react - not to what they need to react to, but to the survival hormones that are coursing through their veins."

I had a pretty good day. I probably spent way too much time outside shoveling but I'm glad I got it done. I needed to create a way for us to get out of the house. I'm surprised by how much effort it took. It was a definite workout. I have a lot to do tomorrow as well. I should probably start with an alarm. I should run too. 2-3 miles should be my goal. I need to spend more time in Gemini tomorrow. I know I will just given where I'll be and what I need to complete.

Date 2026-01-27

I am on a precipice happy for where I am but generally unsatisfied. I am still hungry. I feel like I can do more. The feelings of fulfillment and accomplishment are fleeting feelings that do not provide any lasting comfort. The strive, the grind, the continuous improvement feels right. Feels as though I am using the energy God is giving me. Using it to better myself in the right ways. I do feel a deep calling to this pursuit. My salvation is not found in the pursuit however my God drives me forward.

Book notes:

"We decide what we will make of each and every situation."

Book notes

"It was this intense self discipline and alertness that allowed Rockefeller to seize advantage from obstacle after obstacle in his life. He was inclined to see the opportunity in every disaster. He had the strength to resist temptation or excitement no matter how seductive no matter the situation."

"Rockefeller was resilient, adaptable, calm, brilliant. He could not be rattled. Not by economic crisis not by a glittery mirage of false opportunities, not by aggressive, bullying enemies."

"What matters most is not what these obstacles are but how we see them, how we react to them, and whether we keep our composure. This reaction determines how successful we will be in overcoming them."

"Seen properly, everything that happens - be it economic crash or a personal tragedy - is a chance to move forward. Even if it is on a bearing we did not anticipate."

"This is how you see the opportunity within the obstacle it does not happen on its own. It is a process - one that results from self-discipline and logic."

"Choose not to be harmed - and you won't feel harmed. Don't feel harmed - and you haven't been."

Marcus Aurelius

"Do not surrender the freedoms that are innately ours. Our attitudes, our choices."

Date 2016-1-22

2nd half of today drained me but I got done what needed to get done. I feel like tomorrow is going to be a challenge to get out of bed. But my clothes are ready to go so lets see if I can get one to two miles out of myself. I am happy for the patience I showed my team during the conversation we had about work. I hope they thought it was a productive conversation. I need to consider how I can communicate better for their sake and mine.

Date 2016-01-26

What a massive snow storm blew through yesterday. I have a foot of snow I need to figure out how to displace in my driveway. I don't think I've ever seen so much snow fall at one time before. I'm working today but I need to get out and do some shoveling as well. Wondering if this is going to be a good week. Should be as good as I want to make it. Lots to keep me busy. Hopefully I'll get an architect this week and I can get started on the kitchen work. I have a lot of Verizon work stuff to get done as well. I'm having a hard time keeping up with it all but moving things around I should be able to figure it out.

Use Gemini to assess the permit and create a list of architect dependencies. Including HVAC, electrical, gas, etc. Need to make sure this is all accounted for in the estimate.

I need to cut the weeds out of my life less I be overwhelmed by anger, frustration, confusion. I have things in my power that I need to take action on.

A lot happened today. Hit some milestones. Will hopefully schedule the fireplace install tomorrow. Scheduled a conversation with an architect for tomorrow and heard back from Gee with JP. Many moving parts. Will have some good conversations tomorrow as well. Need to hit the treadmill tomorrow to keep my streak alive and possibly ship the donuts. I should see who makes it into the office. It was a good day. My no-mas streak is still going. Need to prioritize that. Great day, good night.

2026-01-22

Book notes:

"All great victories, be they in politics, business, art, or education, involved resolving vexing problems with a potent cocktail of creativity, focus, and daring. When you have a goal, obstacles are actually teaching you how to get where you want to go — carving you a path. 'The things which hurt,' Ben Franklin wrote, 'instruct'."

Overcoming obstacles is a discipline of three critical steps: perception, action, will.

Simple but never easy.

I must learn to limit my passions and their control over my life. Separate & from deceptive ones.

decision. I need to find better ways to feed my sugar cravings.

Book notes and passages:

- creating a life formula for thriving not just in spite of whatever happens but because of it.
- Our actions may be impeded but there can be no impeding our intentions or dispositions. Because we can accommodate and adapt. The mind adapts and converts to its own purposes the obstacle to our acting.
- The impediment to action advances action. What stands in the way becomes the way.
- there is always a way out or another route to get to where you need to go. So that our setbacks or problems are always expected and never permanent. Making certain that what impedes us can empower us.
- This philosophic approach is the driving force of self-made men and the success of those in position with great responsibility or great trouble.
- Whatever we face we have a choice: Will we be blocked by obstacles, or will we advance through and over them?

Blocking or chunking habits:

Morning

- wake up before 5
- exercise
- greens

mid morning

- devotional
- meditation
- reading
- writing

evening

- reflection
- bed by 10

day

- no sugar
- chores
- greens

The chunks are morning heavy because of my 9-5

Date 2026-01-20

Rocking this morning so far. Going to bed last night by 10 p.m. I wake up at 1 a.m. then again at 4 a.m. just before my alarm went off. Was downstairs on the treadmill by 4:40 just due to all of the things I need to do when I wake up, in order to wake up. Had the goal of 2 miles and ended up doing 3.25 and I got my pilates in. Got the trash out and had a comfortable paced walk to the train station. Feeling pretty good right now. Let's see if this transition into not getting the work done today that I need to get done. Be mindful of my priorities - what is most important to me and what is one thing I can do today to advance me towards my goals. Today was my first 100% day of the year. Literally 3 weeks in. It was much harder to get here than I expected but it feels good to have done it again. Tomorrow I need to get on the treadmill first thing. At least 2 miles knock it out before 6 a.m. The pilates made me feel good too. I got a lot done at work today powered by the fact I had so few meetings. I'm glad I was able to do the things I had on my list. Tomorrow is a new day with new tasks to complete. Keep it rolling Andrew. I know I can do it.

Date 2026-01-21

My Kobo reader will be a cheap solution for book not taking instead of buying a different Remarkable. I need to chunk my habits into blocks and then schedule them. My probability for completing blocks rises exponentially if I only start a block. Write how I feel after I make decisions. Frosted flakes make me feel bad and bloated. Better than Krups, but still not a great.

goe by the end of today and share with him something for the content transformation work. I need to spend some time in front of Gemini to unpack my thinking and get some juice to help me move forward. But first I need to spend some time reading.

"Would you have a great empire? Rule over yourself."

- Publilius Syrus

Control your emotions.

Reflecting on my day. A lot of things went right but there are still opportunities for improvement. I did adequately prepare for my early start tomorrow. Got my chores knocked out and in bed fairly early. Hopefully I can get good sleep tonight. I spent a few hours working prepping for this week but I'm not sure it was enough. Better than nothing though. I need to wake up at four and try to run two miles and pilates. That's all I need to do tomorrow. Two miles and pilates. That is achievable with plenty of time to spare. I did well today. I will work to do better tomorrow.

Date 2026-01-14

do I know of any credible doctoral programs that topic is aligned to, are they local to me or not are they hybrid or fully online? How can I explore acceptance into a program? Can I begin exploring, researching, writing now to build a resume for a program? Is that even necessary? Can I turn some of that writing into blog posts? Is that valuable to me? Would it make me appear valuable in the market - Is having a PhD more valuable than a DBA? To me? To the market? How the heck would I pay for this? Can I network to find possible solution paths? How would that research make me better at my job. Can I leverage that somehow to get Verizon to pay for it? They will pay for a Masters can I swing that into a doctorate? We have a pretty good relationship with Rutgers, what programs do they offer? How would or could my research focus my conversations and strategy with my existing team - Can I consider my current team and circumstances a live testing ground? And then potentially write on the tests and results?

Date 2026-01-19

Am trying to make things happen today and so far so good. I didn't wake up early because I didn't go to bed on time last night. That is something I absolutely need to do tonight. But as of now I feel him rolling but I need to work to keep the momentum going in my favor. I need to work on my goals today for VAS and then extend them out for my other teams. I need to email

Date 2020-01-13

Waymaker, miracle worker, promise keeper, light in the darkness. Your names give me hope. They excite me and make me love you, rely on you more deeply. You speak to me. You connect with me. I don't understand it but I don't have to. I just don't want to fight against it. Run from it. Marginalize it. Soften my heart so that I might continue to hear you and respond.

The book I am reading is also resonating with me helping to guide me to reframing circumstances in a positive light and to act. The impediment to action disappears. The obstacle in the way becomes the way.

There are many opportunities in front of me right now and I am feeling great pressure and expectation and a pulling in many different directions. I need to focus my time only on the activities and goals that are meaningful and will help me move towards my goals and vision. Which means I need clarity. Clarity coupled with bold action. Creating strategy is difficult especially when working with talent. How can I further use my time to grow my strengths and ability in this vein?

Date 2020-01-14

I had a lot of train thoughts this morning. I would prefer not to talk about how those thoughts made me feel but rather to capture those thoughts to try to expound upon them further. My main thinking or central idea was around a specific thesis or dissertation topic focusing on distributed system theory in large scale organizations. From there I jump a bit. Thinking about

Right now is the time for action. Now, before the mind can step in and rationalize differently or find a loophole or way out. Now. I set the orders and then I execute. There is no debate or negotiation. Just action. Goko Willich and Marcus Aurelius are on the same page. I need to get in line that once orders are given, I execute. There is no impeding my intention, or disposition. I can accommodate and adapt. I must remember that the impediment to action advances action. Fortune favors the bold.

My hope is in my God alone. So much is variable, subject to change. My vision lacks my perception, my perspective all conceal, are limited. I don't know what's good or bad. What's on my path or obstructing it. But I know my hope is secure in God. That hope empowers me to act with confidence. God is my unmovable anchor. No excuses, just relentless movement forward. No judgement just love and acceptance and forgiveness and mercy and grace. I know what I must do and I can take action with a confidence that the outcome doesn't matter. The habit, the drive, the effort does. Everyday pushing forward one more step.

Date 2026-01-05

Who knew I need to progress towards waking up early again. Over the last two weeks I have effectively undone my routine of going to bed early and waking up early. I need to acknowledge that I am overly susceptible to social media. Particularly reddit and pinterest and they are taking me down paths I know I shouldn't be going down. Instead I should be focusing my attention on more productive activity. This has been a long and crazy day. I'm glad to finally be crashing in my hotel bed. It's always a trek getting to Vegas and I'm already ready to go back home. I'm so tired. I'm trying to do better.

Date 2026-01-11

"Our actions may be impeded, but there can be no impeding our intentions or dispositions. Because we can accommodate and adapt. The mind adapts and converts to its own purposes the obstacle to our acting. The impediment to action advances action. What stands in the way becomes the way."

Marcus Aurelius

Objective judgement, now at this very moment. Unselfish action, now at this very moment. Willing acceptance - now at this very moment - of all external events. That's all you need.

Marcus Aurelius

so much for consistency. No time like the present to try to get things back on track once again.

Things I need to do today:

Time to reset and get back to it.

I had a good day today. Tomorrow will be better. This was a step in the right direction. I enjoyed my walk with Eli and will try to do it again tomorrow. He's asking to spend time with me. He's willingly telling me about his experiences. I need to make sure I'm listening to him, hearing him. Validating and supporting him. I need to also find ways to bond with Milo. I do love my kids so much. Getting a doctorate has been weighing heavily on my mind lately. I think it's because we been watching so much Big Bang Theory and they normalize having a Ph.D. I try to reflect and understand why I desire one so badly and honestly I can't come up with anything more than I want the achievement. And validation because I'm wildly insecure but I'm working on that. I get a strange feeling thinking about earning a doctorate after my dad passes away and for some reason it diminishes the desire. But why would I want my dad to see me earn it? I know he is already incredibly proud of me.